unfamiliar. This is an industry that pushes the envelope of human ability, that dares to bend the laws of physics, and whose threshold for risk is beyond imagination. The person at the top of such a pyramid must exhibit a similar kind of leadership. Rabin would approve the most daring of operations, but not before he was convinced of the need for them and was certain that the chosen course of action involved only the risks that were absolutely necessary. And from the moment he approved the operation, he radiated a quiet confidence that was felt by the entire hierarchy. Whenever he was presented with an idea, an operation, or a plan, you got the feeling that for him it was "déjà vu," that he had already been here before. Thus, as the executor of the plan, you yourself could be calm and self-confident.

He was not a man with whom you would sit and have a long chat. The chummy, slap-on-the-back culture was not his style. He would sit across from you, leaning back on his chair, or leaning forward on his knees, the perpetual cigarette between his fingers, staring at you with his piercing blue gaze, examining you and listening to you and examining you again, and only after countless tests deciding you were worthy of his trust and support. But once he did, you knew that he would always have your back.

Yitzhak Rabin lived seventy-three years that were rich in deeds and made a unique contribution to the revival of the Jewish people in its country. Like Moses, he was stopped when he was just on the verge of completing his mission. Even had it been in his hands, he could not have planned a better time to leave us. He did so at the height of his life—he went by a whirlwind into heaven. This is, of course, my subjective view, and this is not the place to enter into a rational-empirical discussion in order to prove it.

The world's response and the immense respect that global leaders paid him at his funeral were a profound testimony to his greatness.

There is no doubt that Rabin was murdered against the background of the Oslo Accords. There is no doubt that the rally in Jerusalem's Zion Square on October 5, 1995, was a formative event in this matter, as was the October 10 event at the Wingate Institute, which was a direct continuation of the previous one. The unbridled demonstrations in front of Rabin's home, against him and his wife Leah, broke all the rules.

Without going into a political polemic, I feel that some would find it interesting to hear the insights of the director of the Mossad at the time (myself) regarding Rabin's position on the Oslo process.